Guided Example – Creating Your Own Kanban Board

This example shows step by step how to build a Kanban board from scratch using MS Whiteboard.

Step 1 – Start with User Stories

Choose 2 user stories from your backlog. Example:

1. **Data Cleaning**
   As a data scientist, I want to clean raw CSV data so that I can use it for training a model.
2. **Dashboard Creation**
   As a product owner, I want a simple dashboard of model results so that I can make business decisions.

Step 2 – Break Down into Tasks

For each user story, create smaller tasks:

- **Data Cleaning**
  - Load CSV file into pandas.
  - Remove missing values.
  - Normalize numeric columns.
  - Save cleaned dataset.
- **Dashboard Creation**
  - Define dashboard layout (sketch).
  - Create matplotlib/plotly graphs.
  - Build dashboard app structure.
  - Deploy on Streamlit.

👉 Each task will be represented as **one sticky note** in MS Whiteboard.

Step 3 – Design the Kanban Columns

A basic structure might be:

- **To Do** → all tasks not started.
- **In Progress** → tasks currently being worked on.
- **Review** → tasks completed but pending check by another team member.
- **Done** → fully finished tasks.

💡 *Tip: You can add extra columns like "Blocked" if needed.*

Step 4 – Define WIP Limits

To prevent overload, set a **Work In Progress limit** for the "In Progress" column.

- Example: *Maximum 3 tasks at a time in “In Progress”*.
- Write the rule at the top of the column in Whiteboard.

Step 5 – Make Policies Explicit

Agree with your team on simple rules:
- Each person can only take 1 task at a time.
- A task must be moved to “Review” before going to “Done”.
- Blocked tasks should be tagged with a red sticky note.

Step 6 – Build the Board in MS Whiteboard

- Create 4 rectangles or use a table to form columns.
- Add **sticky notes** for each task.
- Use different colors per User Story (e.g., blue = Data Cleaning, green = Dashboard Creation).
- Place all tasks initially in “To Do”.

Step 7 – Simulate the Workflow

Move sticky notes as if you were executing tasks:
- Pick one note → move it to “In Progress”.
- Once finished, place it into “Review” (someone else must check it).
- After approval, move it into “Done”.

Final Board (Example)

Columns: To Do | In Progress | Review | Done
WIP Limit: In Progress → Max 3
Policies: Only 1 task per person; tasks must pass through Review; use red notes for blocked tasks.

Visual representation (simplified):

To Do	In Progress (Max 3)	Review	Done
Load CSV	Normalize columns	Graphs checked	Save cleaned data
Remove NaNs	Build dashboard app		Deploy Streamlit
Sketch layout			

Reflection

At the end, ask yourself:
- Did the WIP limits avoid overload?
- Did you spot bottlenecks (e.g., many tasks stuck in Review)?
- What changes would improve your workflow in a real project?